5.3 Hurricanes

Video: Hurricanes (Edpuzzle Original)

What Are Hurricanes?

Hurricanes are powerful, _____ storms that form over the _____.

They form where the climate is warm and _____, usually near the _____ in areas called the tropics.

That is why hurricanes are also called _____.

How a Hurricane Forms

Warm tropical water heats the air above it. The warm air _____, carrying moisture.
This leaves an area of lower air _____ beneath the rising air.
Air moving from high-pressure to low-pressure areas is called _____.
When the winds begin to rotate, it is called a tropical _____.

Stage	What happens
Tropical depression	Winds begin to rotate
Tropical _____	Winds reach 39 miles per hour, and the storm gets a _____
Hurricane	The storm keeps speeding up

Hurricanes have higher wind speeds and lower air pressure than tropical storms. In some places they are called typhoons or _____.

Rating Hurricanes

Hurricanes are rated by _____ from Category 1 to Category 5.

The _____ is the spot in the middle where the air pressure is lowest. It is the calmest area of the storm.

Hurricanes on the Move

Hurricanes start to lose strength when they hit _____ water or run onto land.

Hurricanes can cause flooding from heavy rain or a rise in sea level called a _____.

Forecasting and Staying Safe

Meteorologists use _____ technology and remote sensors to forecast storms days or weeks in advance.

The _____ shows where a storm is and where it could go. It gets wider because we are less certain over time, not because the storm gets bigger.

Think About It

Why is it important to take storm warnings seriously? _____